



PGTI president Kapil Dev keen to “raise the bar”



President of the Professional Golf Tour of India (PGTI), Kapil Dev, expressed his delight at being able to elevate the overall vibrancy of the sport through an expanded calendar and total prize money of Rs. 33 crore, while unveiling the schedule for the second half of the season at the Delhi Golf Club.

The upcoming stretch features a packed lineup, beginning with the Rs. 1 crore Coal India Open in Ahmedabad on August 3.

Three events for the NextGen category will be held in Patna, Lucknow, and Bhubaneswar, with Rs. 20 lakh on offer at each.

PGTI Chief Executive Officer Amandeep Johl highlighted that the DP World India Championship — a USD 4 million event scheduled at the iconic Delhi Golf Club from October 16 to 19 — would alone offer nearly Rs. 35 crore in prize money.

Kapil underlined the importance of improving player livelihoods, noting the typically short career span of about 15 years in professional golf. “From next year, we want to have events with a minimum prize money of two crore rupees,” he said, reaffirming his intent to “raise the bar” for Indian golf and bring it closer in stature to cricket.

KAMESH SRINIVASAN

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The second Women’s Kabaddi World Cup, scheduled to be held in Hyderabad from August 3 to 10 at the Gachibowli Indoor Stadium, has been indefinitely postponed. This marks the second rescheduling of the event, which was originally set to take place in Bihar in June. In a letter to the International Kabaddi Federation (IKF), seen by *Sportstar*, the Amateur Kabaddi Federation of India (AKFI) stated that the decision was made due to the “non-timely submissions of team contingent administrative details,” which created issues in “obtaining clearances from the concerned Ministries.” The AKFI also clarified that it would not accept any changes to the existing list of participating countries, stating that it would “derail the administrative process for timely clearances.”

The 14 participating nations include Argentina, Bangladesh, Chinese Taipei, Germany, the Netherlands, Iran, Japan, Kenya, Nepal, Thailand, Uganda, Zanzibar, Poland, and India.

According to multiple sources, the tournament is now expected to be held in Hyderabad after the conclusion of the Pro Kabaddi League, which begins in Vizag on August 29.

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